

A final objection is quite different, and in some ways more worrying.

Let us suppose for purposes of argument that the conclusion of Leibniz's argument is true, and hence that the following is true:



God brings about
the existence of
contingent things

This must be either necessary, or contingent. But either path leads to trouble.

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the text.

contingent



necessary



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

argument is true, and hence that the following is true:

Let us suppose for purposes of argument that the conclusion of Leibniz's

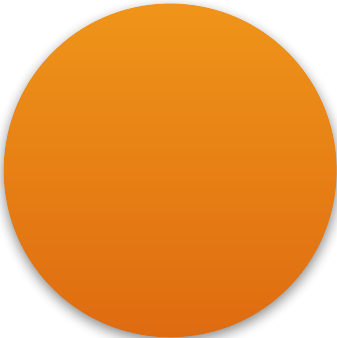


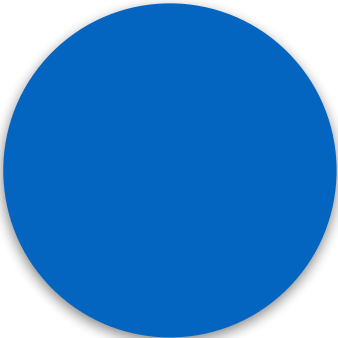


contingent things

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troubled.





... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

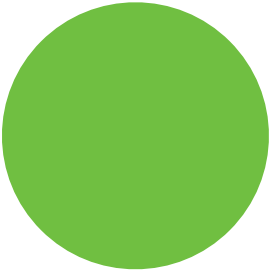
Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

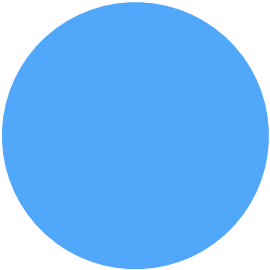
What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.





the
PSR







cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

be Good.

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

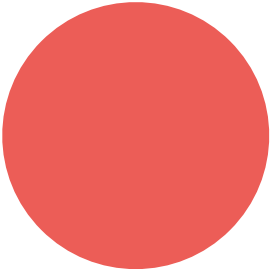


Leibniz's
argument





Leibniz's
argument





objections
to the
PSR



A large, solid green circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "God brings about the existence of contingent things" is written in a white, monospaced, typewriter-style font. The text is arranged in four lines, centered horizontally within the circle.

God brings about
the existence of
contingent things

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contingent



necessary



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